

HOUSE JOINT RESOLUTION 1643

By Salinas

A RESOLUTION to honor the Vollintine and Evergreen Greenline on the occasion of its thirtieth anniversary.

WHEREAS, the members of this General Assembly are pleased to recognize those parks and natural areas that are celebrating historic milestones of preserving natural and cultural resources for both the Tennesseans of today and generations to come; and

WHEREAS, one such public space is the Vollintine and Evergreen Greenline in Memphis, which is celebrating its thirtieth anniversary this year; and

WHEREAS, the Vollintine and Evergreen (V&E) Greenline was established in 1996 by community volunteers in Memphis's Vollintine Evergreen district, making it one of the State's first rail-to-trail projects; and

WHEREAS, in 1995, the Vollintine Evergreen Community Association secured grant funding for a major community revitalization effort and, on November 11, 1996, purchased the abandoned right-of-way, officially renaming it the V&E Greenline; and

WHEREAS, today, the V&E Greenline is an integral part of a culturally rich and diverse community, and its vibrant, unpaved walking and biking trail stretches from Crosstown Concourse to Springdale Street; and

WHEREAS, the trail features two bridges, a stationhouse, an extensive canopy of oak trees, several art sculptures, shade and sun gardens, and diverse wildlife, particularly near Lick Creek; and

WHEREAS, the V&E Greenline is supported by residents and trail users alike, with a dedicated group of volunteers that manage and maintain the trail; and

WHEREAS, over the years, the trail has received numerous awards and recognitions, including Trail of the Month from the Rails-to-Trails Conservancy, Outstanding Grassroots

Organization from the *Memphis Flyer*, and the Best Practice Award from the U.S. Department of Housing and Urban Development; and

WHEREAS, the Vollintine and Evergreen Greenline has remained a true treasure of this State for three decades, and it is most fitting that we specially recognize its dedicated volunteers and invaluable supporters on this special occasion; now, therefore,

BE IT RESOLVED BY THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES OF THE ONE HUNDRED FOURTEENTH GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE, THE SENATE CONCURRING, that we honor the Vollintine and Evergreen Greenline on the occasion of its thirtieth anniversary and extend our gratitude to its volunteers and supporters for their service to the people of Tennessee.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that an appropriate copy of this resolution be prepared for presentation with this final clause omitted from such copy and upon proper request made to the appropriate clerk, the language appearing immediately following the State seal appear without House or Senate designation.